

(NOTE: You will find the same procedure in Appendix A of this book.) We made only two other changes. First, she closed out her old account and opened a new one (no one could figure out how much was actually in the old account). Second, I had her start using a checkbook that provided a carbon copy of every check written, so the amount was always certain. From that point on, she always balanced her account properly every month. This was not a stupid woman. She was a high-school math teacher with a graduate degree. She was intelligent, but ignorant. As Proverbs 27:23 says, "Know well the condition of your flocks, and pay attention to your herds." In other words, know what you're doing!

GREED

The second source of financial problems is greed. What does greed mean? "You have to have more, and you have to have the best." Today greed is accepted as normal. In our generation, it's taught under the guise that you OWE it to yourself, or go ahead and buy it because somebody else has one too. The only way to overcome that philosophy is to ask, "What is God's plan for me? I don't want somebody else's plan."

Perhaps God wants you to live in an apartment complex for a while so that you can witness to people there. After all, God has to have His people stationed in apartment complexes around the country, doesn't He?

I think of a young couple I'll call Ben and Mary who made a conscious decision to live God's plan for their lives and not someone else's. Ben was an engineer with an MBA from Harvard. Mary was the only daughter of a very wealthy family. They were living in a very affluent section of their city with the best of what the "world" has to offer, when Ben felt very strongly that God would have them move to a transitional neighborhood in the inner city.

Both of their families tried to talk them out of moving. But they were certain that they were to have a ministry in an area that most middle-class families had abandoned. Within a year, they had sold their BMW, and Ben had quit his engineering job